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FROM TOKYO TO FOREIGN OFFICE.

Cypher/OTP.

FOREIGN OFFICE AND WHITEHALL DISTRIBUTION.

Sir E. Dening.
No: 70.
16th January, 1952.

D: 9.11 a.m. 16th January, 1952.
R: 9.30 a.m. 16th January, 1952.

EMERGENCY.
CONFIDENTIAL.

Addressed to Foreign Office telegram No: 70 of 16th January

Repeated for information to: Washington (Immediate).
Singapore.
Hong Kong.

Sino-Japanese relations.

Special assistant to Japanese Vice Minister for Foreign Affairs called on the Minister this morning and handed him a copy of a letter from the Japanese Prime Minister to Mr. Dulles on the China question. Mr. Shima said that the letter was being submitted at that very moment to the Cabinet, no member of whom, except the Prime Minister, was aware of its existence, and that it would be released to the press concurrently in Tokyo and Washington (by the State Department) at 1000 hours Japanese time. Text is contained in my immediately following telegram. Letter is dated 24th December, i.e. after Mr. Dulles's departure from Japan.

2. Minister asked Mr. Shima to thank the Japanese Government for its courtesy in giving this mission advance knowledge of publication of the letter. At the same time he wished to emphasise that this question of the two Chinas was one the decision regarding which His Majesty's Government had always regarded as lying exclusively with the Japanese Government and that consequently His Majesty's Government had scrupulously avoided putting any pressure on the Japanese Government either one way or another. Mr. Shima, who was very apologetic in his manner and explained quite frankly that until this morning he was in complete ignorance of the latter, said that from the Japanese point of view the essential thing was that there should be no obstacle to the ratification by the United States Senate of the Treaty. He then added

artlessly that.....

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artlessly that he did not know why this moment should have been selected for publication.

Foreign Office please pass to Washington as my telegram No: 4 Immediate, and to Singapore and Hong Kong as my telegrams Nos: 13 and 4 respectively.

[Repeated to Washington and Singapore. Copies sent to Telegraph Section Colonial Office for repetition to Hong Kong].

ADVANCE COPIES:

Sir W. Strang.
Private Secretary.
Mr. R.H. Scott.
Head of Japan and Pacific Department.

JJJJJ

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